Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Vincent Van Faux

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Vincent Van Faux

Celebrated Contemporary Painter

Vincent believes even his shopping lists belong in a documentary. He is truly a genius of the visual arts. Vincent became famous young and has been trying ever since to convince people that this is not the same thing as becoming famous accidentally.

- Went to art school with **Dada DiCapo**. **Dada** enjoys reminding Vincent of this in front of collectors.
- **Penny Pincher** keeps showing Vincent photos of paintings and asking what they are worth. He's not interested.
- **Al Baster** compares their commissions by weight. Vincent would prefer to discuss the price.

ACTING TIPS

Warm, competitive, mercurial, self-aware enough to joke about his ego but not enough to lose it.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Vincent Van Faux. My new work is here tonight. My early work is also here, despite several very expensive objections.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Vincent Van Faux

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Early fame froze him as a young prodigy. He envies Dada's ability to move forward and fears he has already made his best work.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Vincent Van Faux

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Find the biography of the man who chose conscience over obedience. Its pages have company.*

2 *Look inside the vessel that usually gives cut flowers a place to stand.*

3 *Find the green light, then examine the space nearby.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Vincent Van Faux

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

He kept exhibiting the early picture. My breakthrough, apparently. I painted it to pay rent. Now he'd commissioned the bottle study and wanted to print it beside his rescue announcement. I withdrew permission. The dealer told me to be less difficult. Dada, you kept making new work while I got invited to explain the old one. Grant liked having that old version of me on his wall.

IF MURDERER

He kept exhibiting the early picture. My breakthrough, apparently. I painted it to pay rent. Now he wanted the bottle study printed beside his rescue announcement. I withdrew permission; he could hold my final payment. The dealer told me to be less difficult. Dada, you kept making new work. Grant could buy another picture from me and still introduce me as the boy who painted his first.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Vincent Van Faux

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I crossed the reproduction off the handout proof and showed the collectors the painting. The bottle came from a sale photograph. I made a studio model to work out the light. At the preview I saw Grant's acquired bottle. My studio things weren't in his loan. The dealer could sell the whole arrangement. I would still like to be asked first.

IF MURDERER

I crossed reproduction off the proof and showed the collectors the painting. I'd used a sale photograph and a studio model for the light. I attended the preview. Later I took Grant's unsigned reproduction release to his place. His glass caught the light there, too. He wasn't around. I left the release beside it. The dealer could sell the arrangement. My painting wasn't a signature on every object put beside it.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The model is painted wood. You can see the joints. I delivered a painting of the glass bottle, using the sale photograph. The real bottle stood at the preview. Grant threatened my last payment when I withdrew permission to print the painting. Dada, I envied your work. I still do.

IF MURDERER

> My wooden model was on the preview support. The acquired bottle was withheld. The reference sheet describes the original; it isn't a photograph of the installed prop. The delivery list doesn't name every presentation item. Grant was holding my last payment over printing rights. I had had enough of him.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

BALLOT

Vincent Van Faux

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My model was wood; the loan was glass. The delivery list separates the painting from the object. I withdrew reproduction permission even with payment outstanding. I also let Grant sell a grander story about my early work than it deserved. Dada, I owe you a conversation without collectors listening. Bring the bad student paintings. I could stand to remember what trying felt like.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The preview bottle was his acquired original, not my studio model. I used the model story to make the source sound harmless. I took poison during the preview and later put it in his waiting glass. My delivery list never included a model; the intake photograph showed his bottle. He had bought a picture. Dada kept making work. I kept wanting someone else to remove the man who made me feel small. There is no picture I can paint that excuses doing it myself.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.